Godzilla Stars Bring Hollywood Cheers Back to Tokyo

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Fans were shouting the director's name like a rock star's.

At the 39th Tokyo International Film Festival on Sunday, the stars of Godzilla Minus Zero relived the film's **premiere** in Los Angeles, two days before the new movie opens in Japan. Kamiki Ryunosuke returns as Shikishima Koichi, and Hamabe Minami returns as his wife Noriko. Both had flown back to Japan only two days earlier from the **premiere** at the TCL Chinese Theatre.

Kamiki said the energy was extraordinary and that feeling the enthusiasm firsthand reminded him how deeply Godzilla is loved around the world. Applause in the 900-seat theater reportedly continued without a break. Some fans wore Godzilla-themed outfits or badges, held large posters, and asked for **autographs**. When director Yamazaki Takashi went to sign, the crowd erupted again, with chants of 'TAKASHI!' from the red carpet, which was open to passersby.

The Tokyo event was also the first stage appearance of child actor Nagatani Sae, who returns as Akiko. In Godzilla Minus One, she was very young and her part was mostly crying or single words. This time, Kamiki said, she had memorized full **dialogue** perfectly. Hamabe said Nagatani had grown into a dependable young actor who chatted with them and taught them things.

According to Kamiki, the new story picks up about two years after Minus One, while Hamabe put the gap at two to three years. The family has settled into everyday life before Godzilla resurfaces.

Minus One **grossed** more than 7.65 billion yen, or $50 million, in Japan, won the **visual effects** prize at the Oscars, and collected more than 50 honors. Minus Zero is described as the first Japanese film **certified** as Filmed for Imax.

Word Treasure

premiere -- The first public showing of a new film.

autographs -- Famous people's signatures, often written for fans as keepsakes.

dialogue -- The words characters speak to each other in a film or play.

visual effects -- Images created or changed with computers to show things that are hard to film for real.

grossed -- Earned a stated amount of money from ticket sales, before costs are taken away.

certified -- Officially approved as meeting a particular standard.

Background you need

Godzilla is a giant monster from Japanese films that has become famous around the world.

Godzilla Minus Zero is the follow-up to Godzilla Minus One, and its returning characters include Shikishima Koichi, his wife Noriko and their daughter Akiko.

Film festivals bring actors, directors and fans together to celebrate new movies, often with red-carpet events and stage appearances.

Minus One was a huge success in Japan and won the visual effects prize at the Oscars, so excitement for the new film is high.

Break it down

LEAD: The stars of Godzilla Minus Zero brought Hollywood-style cheers back to Tokyo at the film festival.

KEY EVENT: Kamiki Ryunosuke and Hamabe Minami appeared on stage days after the Los Angeles premiere.

+- WHO: The returning actors, director Yamazaki Takashi, and child actor Nagatani Sae

+- FAN REACTION: Fans wore Godzilla outfits, held posters, asked for autographs and chanted the director's name

EVIDENCE: Kamiki said the enthusiasm reminded him how deeply Godzilla is loved around the world.

OPEN QUESTION: The new story picks up about two to three years after Minus One, as Godzilla resurfaces.

Why it matters

The event shows how a Japanese film series can excite fans in different countries at the same time. It also highlights the success of Minus One, which earned major honors before this follow-up.

Test what you remember

1. At which festival did the Godzilla Minus Zero stars appear in Tokyo?

- (A) A Los Angeles premiere only
- (B) The TCL Chinese Theatre event
- (C) The Oscars
- (D) The 39th Tokyo International Film Festival

2. Where had the film's Los Angeles premiere taken place?

- (A) On a red carpet open to passersby
- (B) At the Oscars ceremony
- (C) In a 900-seat theater in Tokyo
- (D) At the TCL Chinese Theatre

3. Which child actor made her first stage appearance at the Tokyo event?

- (A) Nagatani Sae, who returns as Akiko
- (B) Yamazaki Takashi
- (C) Hamabe Minami
- (D) Kamiki Ryunosuke

4. How long after Minus One does the new story pick up, according to Kamiki?

- (A) Ten years later
- (B) The next day
- (C) More than fifty years later
- (D) About two years later

5. What prize did Minus One win at the Oscars?

- (A) Best actor
- (B) Best dialogue
- (C) Best film
- (D) The visual effects prize

6. How much did Minus One gross in Japan?

- (A) More than 7.65 billion yen, or $50 million
- (B) More than 50 honors
- (C) 900 yen
- (D) About $50 in total

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: A 4: D 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Kamiki Ryunosuke: Kamiki said the energy was extraordinary, that Nagatani had memorized full dialogue perfectly, and that the new story picks up about two years after Minus One.

2. Hamabe Minami: Hamabe said Nagatani had grown into a dependable young actor and put the gap between the films at two to three years.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):